NESA Sentence Starters

HSC Software Engineering · ~25–30 words per mark · ~2 minutes per mark · spelling is not marked, content is

The four moves (every "explain")

Concept → Why / how → Example in the scenario → Effect

1. **[Concept]** is ___ / ___ means ___.
2. **This is because** ___ / This works by ___.
3. **For example, in this scenario** ___.
4. **As a result,** ___ / This means that ___ / Therefore ___.

More points

- **One** [benefit / risk / way / challenge] **is** ___.
- **Another** [benefit / way] **is** ___.
- **Furthermore,** ___ / **In addition,** ___.
- **This is important because** ___.

Other side (discuss / evaluate)

- **However,** ___.
- **On the other hand,** ___.
- **A limitation is that** ___.
- **This could also lead to** ___.

Compare

- **Both** ___ **and** ___ **can** ___.
- **Whereas** ___ does ___, ___ does ___.
- **Unlike** ___, ___ ___.
- **For this scenario,** ___ **is better because** ___.

Judgement (evaluate / assess / justify)

- **This is effective because** ___.
- **This is limited because** ___.
- **Overall,** ___ **because** ___.
- **Therefore, the most suitable** ___ **is** ___.

Question words

Identify	name it, in a sentence
Outline	main features, 1 sentence each
Describe	what it is + how it behaves
Explain	**why / how**: the four moves
Compare	same features, both sides
Discuss	for AND against
Analyse	parts → effects → what matters most
Evaluate	strengths + weaknesses → "Overall…"
Justify	position → reasons + evidence

How much to write

Marks	Words	Time
2–3	60–90	4–6 min
4–5	100–150	8–10 min
6	170–300	12 min
8–10	280–350+	16–20 min

8–10 markers: plan 2 min → opening that answers the question → 3 body paragraphs → "Overall… because…". Take a rest break just before them.

Before moving on, check

□ Did I name the **concept** before giving examples?

□ Is every point linked to **the scenario**?

□ Covered **every part** named (TWO / both sides / judgement)?

□ **Full sentences**, not dot points?

□ **Nothing blank.** A partial answer still earns marks.